

Ethan Zaruba-Walker

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EXPERIENCE

StaffRoom AI

Emeryville, CA

Founder & AI Solutions Consultant

October 2023 - Present

- Run discovery and scoping with the operator, then write the SOW and build the proof. Client work has reached \$18K, with the human remaining the decision-maker.
- Prototype agent flows in Python against Claude, OpenAI, and Gemini APIs, including tool use and MCP. Claude Code is the daily driver for iterating a demo with the customer in the room.
- Own the technical narrative: translate a workflow into a solution design, a demo, and a measured outcome the buyer can repeat back.
- Built an evaluation from the client's ground truth and held it to 95% agreement with human reviewers before anything was treated as good enough to ship.
- Shipped production API integrations in Python and TypeScript, including OAuth and CI that calls the live third-party API, so a pilot is not a slide.
- Automated an MSP's pre-sales risk assessments, cut processing time 98%, and trained their team to extend the workflow after the pilot.
- Feed what breaks in the field back into the next build: a living backlog, revised prompts, and a tighter guardrail, rather than a one-off script.

Valhalla Healthcare

Remote

Machine Learning Engineer (Intern)

May 2021 - August 2021

- Built a Python model that turned handwritten clinical notes into a structured data model (F1 80.03). The interface was one customer, and a person still checked the output.

IBM

Austin, TX

Data Engineer / Cognitive Software Engineer, Customer Support

August 2018 - December 2020

- Wrote release notes and ran Design Thinking sessions so engineers and non-technical stakeholders heard the same explanation of what changed and why.
- Built DRE Bot, a Watson NLP assistant inside Slack, and IBMLogAnalyze, a pipeline that removed 1-3 hours of log prep per case. Presented operational results to C-level readers in Tableau and Cognos.

EDUCATION

University of Colorado Boulder

Boulder, CO

B.S. Information Science (related technical field); Major GPA 3.7 | Certificate of Cognitive Science August 2018 - May 2023

DeepLearning.AI

Online

Deep Learning Specialization | TensorFlow Developer Professional Certificate

January 2021 | May 2020

IBM

Online

Systems & Solutions Architecture Professional Certificate (in progress)

expected July 2026

SKILLS

Sales engineering: discovery, scoping, proofs of concept, solution narratives, executive-readable outcomes, pilot-to-deployment handoff. **Build:** Python, JavaScript/TypeScript, REST APIs, LLM and agent tooling, Claude Code, MCP, prompt and evaluation design. **Adjacent context:** clinical-note ML internship (F1 80.03), EMT certification (2024).